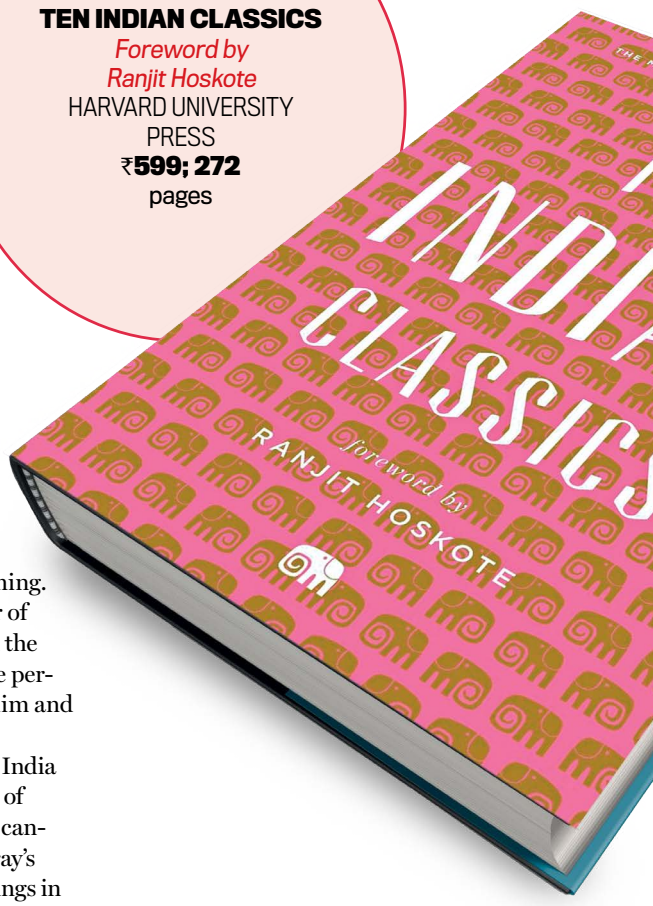
BOOKS

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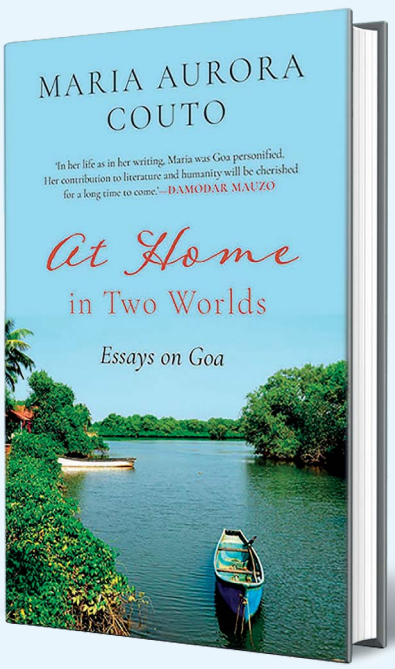
Ranjit Hoskote has curated a stellar anthology of Indian writing through the ages in this offering from the Murty Classical Library of India

TEN INDIAN CLASSICS
Foreword by Ranjit Hoskote
HARVARD UNIVERSITY PRESS
₹599; 272 pages



Some six decades ago, there lived an itinerant vendor called D.K. Murthy. Thin to the point of looking emaciated, wearing diamond studs in his ears, clad in collared shirt and muslin dhoti, he would take the Grand Trunk Express from Madras to 'upper India' with a small cache of classically traditional south Indian jewels. One nondescript year, Murthy just stopped coming. But his legend as the purveyor of 'quality' gems continued. And the genuine articles still adorn the persons who bought them from him and their descendants.

Murty Classical Library of India has placed in our hands a 'box' of 10 gems of translation which I cannot but describe in Thomas Gray's famous words as being renderings in



AT HOME IN TWO WORLDS
Essays on Goa
By Maria Aurora Couto
SPEAKING TIGER
₹499; 216 pages

BOOKS

Inside Out

*The late **Maria Aurora Couto's** essays belong in the long Goan tradition of memoirs as cultural history*

India's smallest state brims with paradoxes, counterfactuals, and what can seem like outright contradictions, which explains why the same is true of the life of Maria Aurora Couto (1937-2022), whose posthumously published *At Home in Two Worlds* is both her best book and the finest explainer of Goa's history and culture.

Couto was eulogised as the "grande dame of letters and culture of Goa" by the academic Peter Ronald deSouza, and the great Konkani writer and Jnanpith Award-winner Damodar Mauzo's assessment of her as "Goa personified" is on the cover of this new book. But a fuller assessment of this tenacious, largely self-made intellectual force must take into account her assiduously cultivated proximities to state power, partly explicable by her IAS administrator husband